

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

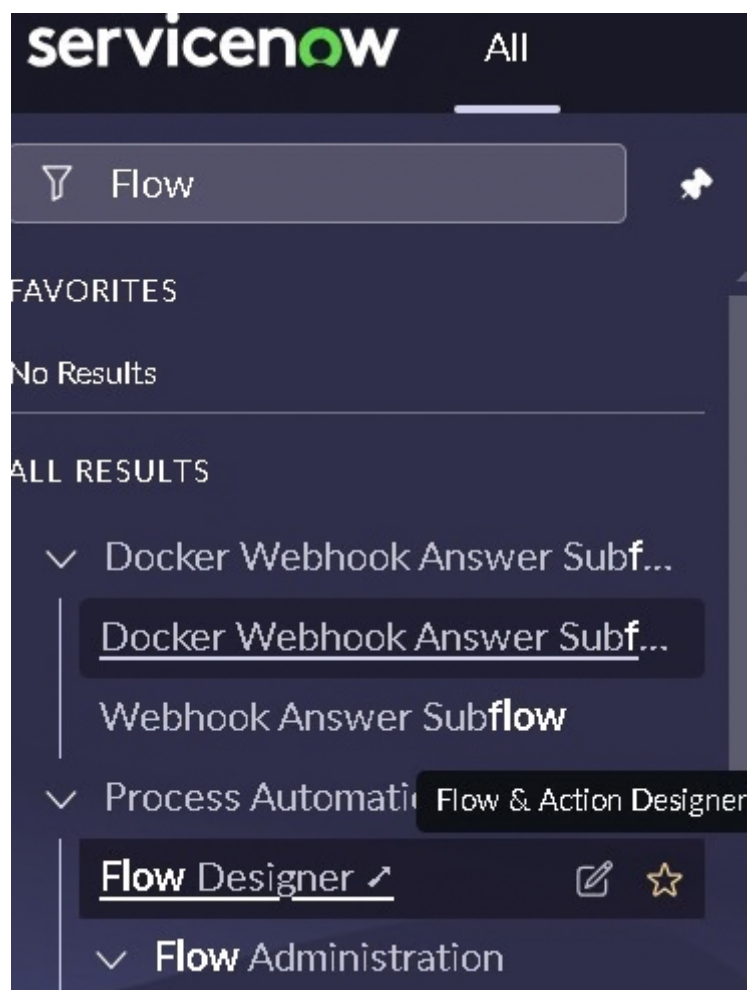
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

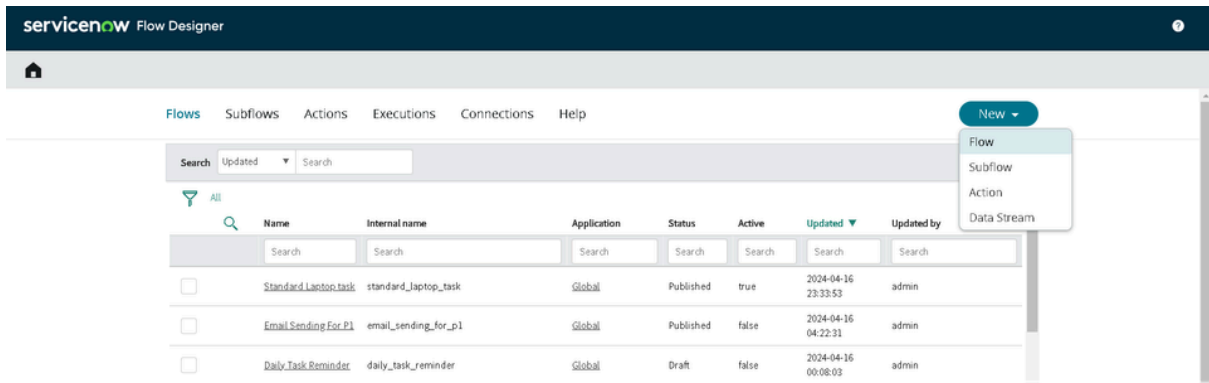
TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.





Flow properties

* Flow name: Standard Laptop task

Description: Describe your flow

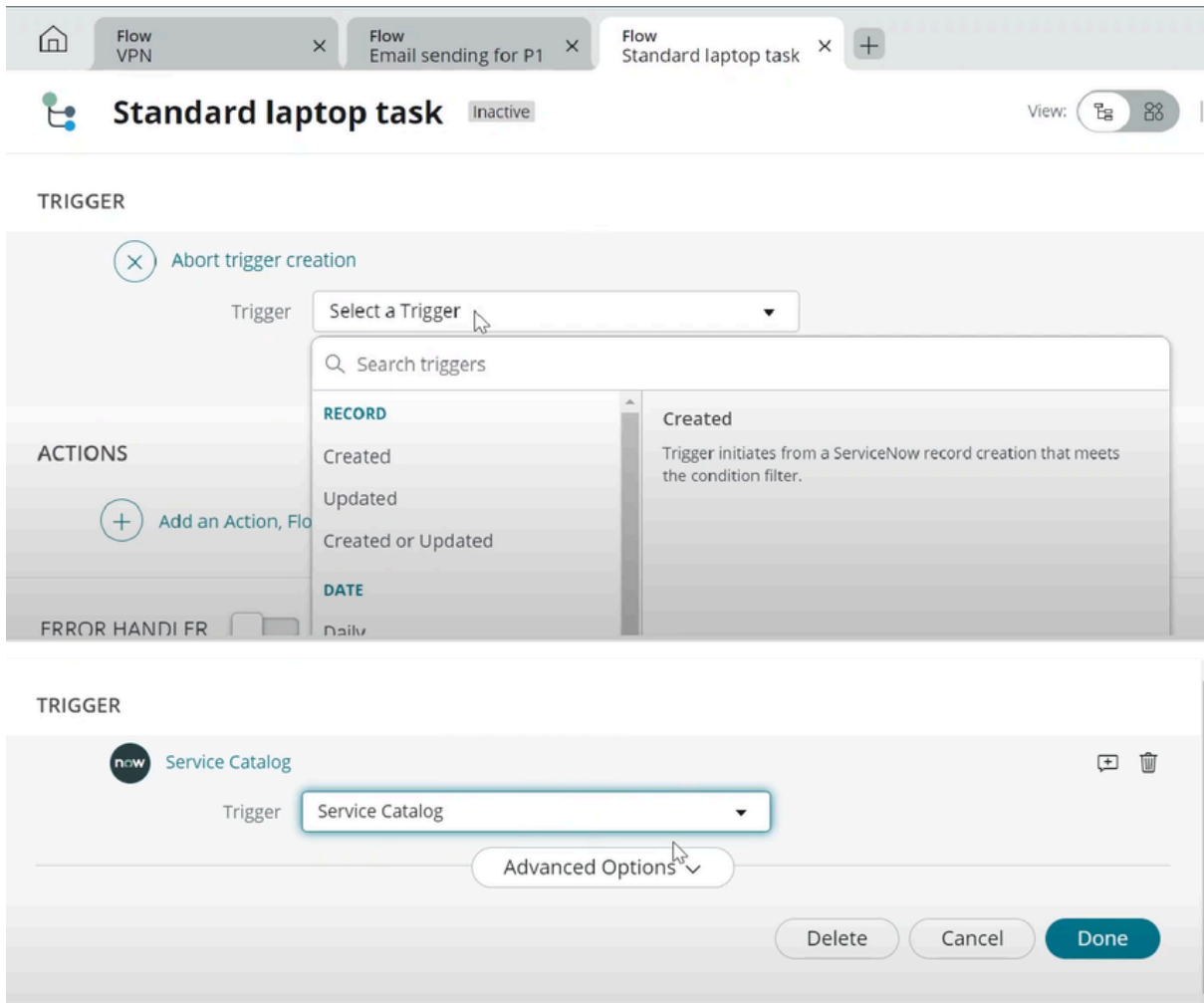
Application: Global

Protection: -- None --

Run As: System User

Cancel Submit

9. Click on Add a trigger
10. Select the trigger in that Search for “ Service Catalog ” and select that.
11. After that click on Done.



12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for " Create Catalog Task " and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as " Laptop need to Configured ".
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as " Laptop need to Configured ".
22. Select Assignment group field and value as " Hardware ".
23. Select Approval field and value as " Approved ".
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



Standard Laptop task

Active



Action

Flow Logic

Subflow

Search Actions

Create Catalog Task



Most Recent



Popular

INSTALLED SPOKES



ServiceNow Core



Connect



AES Portal UI Template



Deployment Pipeline



Virtual Agent



Password Reset



AES Flow Templates



Global

Create Catalog Task

ServiceNow Core

Look Up Record

ServiceNow Core

Wait For Condition

ServiceNow Core

Create Record

ServiceNow Core

SLA Percentage Timer

ServiceNow Core

Send Email

ServiceNow Core

Update Record

ServiceNow Core

Create Template



Standard Laptop task

Active

View:



1



Create Catalog Task

Action

Create Catalog Task

Table Name

Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]

Trigger - ... Requested Item ...

Short Description

Laptop needs to Configured

Fields

Description

X

Laptop needs to Configured

Assignment group

X

Hardware

X

Approval

X

Approved

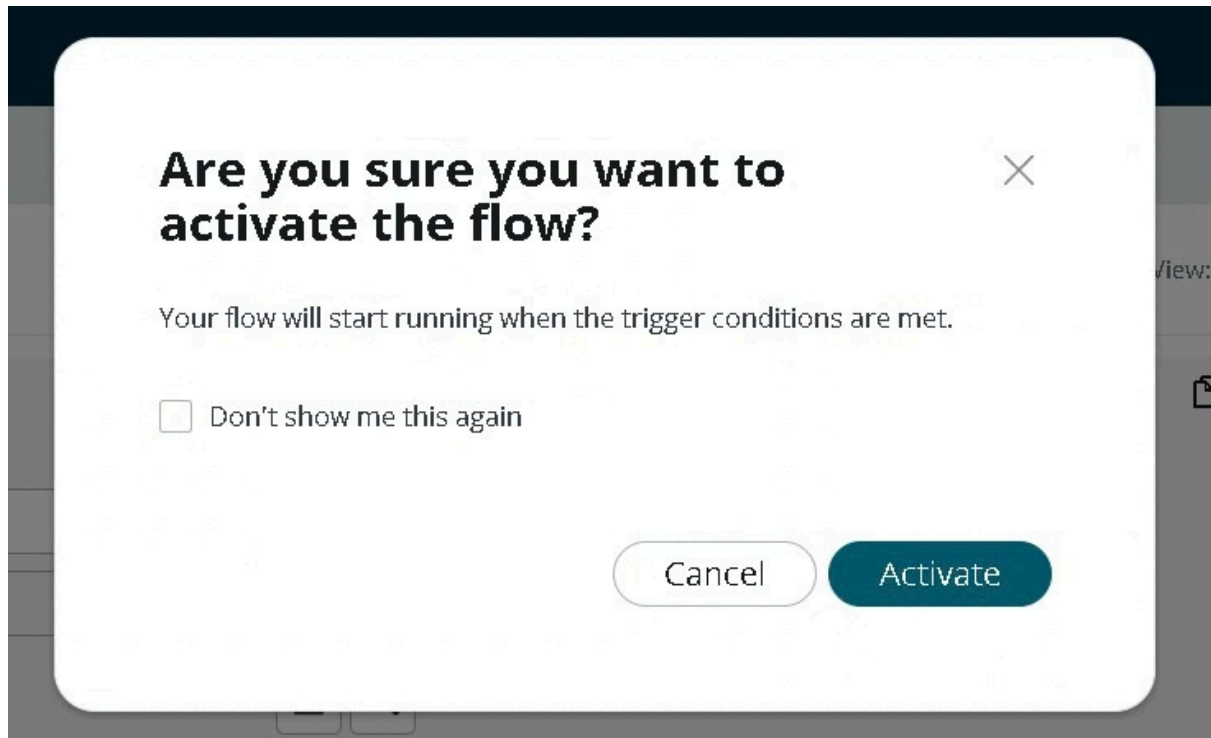
+ Add field value

Wait



Template Catalog

Global Template Catalog



Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for StandardLaptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbonx1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

Catalog Item: Standard Laptop

Name: Standard Laptop

Application: Global

Catalogs: Service Catalog

Category: Hardware

State: -- None --

Checked out: -- None --

Owner:

Active: ☒

Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified

Process Engine

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow: Standard Laptop task

Workflow:

Execution Plan:

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.

Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon
The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

☐ Adobe Acrobat

☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Quantity 1

Subtotal ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Delivery **Order Now** 0 Days

Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart
Empty

5. Now we will see the Order status

6. In that click on the Request Number

Order Status [Back to Catalog](#) [Continue Shopping](#) [Home](#)

✓ Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2024-04-17 04:07:11

Request Number: [REQ0010001](#) ☆

Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2024-04-17

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo - Carbon x1	2024-04-17	▶	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually	1	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually
				Total	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

[Back to Catalog](#) [Continue Shopping](#) [Home](#)

7. It will open the Requested number record.

8. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

Request - REQ0010001

Short description

Special instructions

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links

Show Workflow

Workflow Context

Requested Items (1) **Approvers (1)** Recurring Prices (1)

State Search

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links

Show Workflow

Workflow Context

Requested Items (1) **Approvers (1)** Recurring Prices (1)

State Search

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Requested Item - RITM0010001

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

Impact 3 - Low

Opened by System Administrator

Priority 4 - Low

State Open

Update Delete

Related Links

Flow Context

Catalog Tasks (1) **Approvers** Group approvals

Number Search

Request item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to be Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

1 to 1 of 1

12. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section
13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

The screenshot displays a ServiceNow Catalog Task record for SCTASK0010001. The interface includes a header with navigation icons and buttons for 'Discuss', 'Follow', 'Update', 'Close Task', and 'Delete'. The form is organized into two main columns. The left column contains fields for 'Number' (SCTASK0010001), 'Assigned to' (with a search icon), 'Configuration item' (with a search icon), 'Active' (checked), 'Short description' (Laptop needs to Configured), 'Description' (Laptop needs to Configured), and 'Worknotes' (Worknotes). The right column contains fields for 'Approval' (Approved), 'Priority' (4 - Low), 'State' (Open), 'Request item' (RITM0010001), and 'Requested for' (System Administrator). A 'Post' button is located at the bottom right of the form. The 'Activities' section at the bottom shows 'Activity: 1'.

Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.

